



FOCUS ON... **ALUMINIUM**

This shiny metal can be found in many everyday objects, from cans to sports equipment.



▲ Cans made of pure aluminium are easy to recycle.



▲ Aluminium is both lightweight and strong and is used to make tennis rackets.



▲ Fire-protection suits have an aluminium coating to reflect heat.

Aluminium

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Despite being the most common metal in Earth's rocks, pure aluminium is hard to separate from its minerals. After it was first identified, it took a century to figure out how to make pure aluminium in large amounts. Now it is the second-most utilized metal on Earth, after iron.

ATOMIC MASS 26.982

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1827
(Friedrich Wöhler)

This blue-green ore contains aluminium, phosphorus, and oxygen.

Chunk of green variscite, an ore of aluminium

